

DGads CMS - Client Environment Setup Guide

Step-by-Step Account & Credential Generation Guide for MongoDB Atlas & Cloudinary

Client Guide Overview: This guide outlines how to create your free accounts and generate all required environment variables for **MongoDB Atlas** (Free Database) and **Cloudinary** (Free Media CDN) for your website's CMS.

Part 1: MongoDB Atlas Setup (Free Database)

MongoDB Atlas stores all structured JSON text content (case study details, testimonials, client logos metadata, and contact form lead submissions).

- **Step 1: Sign Up** — Go to mongodb.com/cloud/atlas/register and create a free account.
- **Step 2: Create Free Cluster** — Choose the **M0 (FREE)** cluster tier.
- **Step 3: Create Database User** — Click **Connect** ➡ **Create a Database User**. Enter a username (e.g., `dgads_user`) and password. *Save this password securely!*
- **Step 4: Configure Network Access** — Go to **Network Access** ➡ Click **Add IP Address** ➡ Select **Allow Access From Anywhere (0.0.0.0/0)**.
- **Step 5: Copy Connection String** — Click **Connect** ➡ **Choose Drivers (Node.js)**. Copy the URI string.

Example Connection String (MONGODB_URI):

```
mongodb+srv://dgads_user:YourStrongPassword123!@cluster0.abcd.mongodb.net/dgads_cms?retryWrites=true&w=majority
```

Part 2: Cloudinary Setup (Free Media Storage & CDN)

Cloudinary stores and automatically optimizes all client uploaded images (case study covers, testimonials photos, client brand logos) in WebP format.

- **Step 1: Create Account** — Register for a free account at cloudinary.com/signup.
- **Step 2: Get Cloud Name** — Look at your main Dashboard header and copy your **Cloud Name** (e.g., `dgads-agency`). This is your `VITE_CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME`.
- **Step 3: Create Unsigned Preset** — Click the **Settings Icon** at bottom left ➡ **Upload tab** ➡ Scroll down to **Upload presets** ➡ Click **Add upload preset**.

- **Step 4: Set Unsigned Mode** — Change **Signing Mode** to **Unsigned**. Name your preset (e.g. dgads_preset) and click **Save**. This is your VITE_CLOUDINARY_UPLOAD_PRESET.

Part 3: Complete Environment Variables Reference Table

Variable Name	Sample Value / Description
MONGODB_URI	mongodb+srv://user:pass@cluster0...mongodb.net/dgads_cms
JWT_SECRET	dgads_secret_jwt_key_2026_x89q3 (Random secret key)
ADMIN_USERNAME	admin (Login username for CMS)
ADMIN_PASSWORD	YourAdminPassword123 (Login password for CMS)
VITE_CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME	dgads-agency (From Cloudinary Dashboard)
VITE_CLOUDINARY_UPLOAD_PRESET	dgads_preset (Unsigned upload preset name)